Hernan Mendez

Media Producer | Project Manager

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Media producer and project manager with 10+ years leading photo, video, audio, and multimedia projects from scope and budget through production, post, and delivery. Plans schedules, coordinates crews and vendors, manages logistics and permits, and keeps stakeholders informed so projects land on time and on brief. Hands-on across cinematography, field audio, editing, and digital asset management. Has coordinated documentary crews of up to 45 and handles up to six projects a month in busy periods. Applies generative AI (Claude, ChatGPT) to research, pre-production planning, and documentation through documented, repeatable workflows, with human review and approval on every client-facing output. M.S. in Graphic Information Technology from Arizona State University. Bilingual English/Spanish.

CORE SKILLS

Project Management: Project planning, scoping, scheduling, budgeting, timelines, vendor and crew coordination, stakeholder communication, Agile/Scrum, Trello, process documentation and SOPs, pricing and cost analysis

Media Production: Video production, producing, storyboarding, cinematography, camera operation, multi-camera and live-event coverage, interviews, b-roll, scriptwriting, interview question development, location scouting, permits, livestreaming (live charity auctions, youth sports games), podcast production, stop-motion animation

Photography: Commercial, architectural, real estate, product, editorial, and event photography; lighting design; 360° virtual tours

Audio: Field recording, lav and boom, tape-sync and remote interviews, dialogue editing, mixing

Post-Production: Adobe Premiere Pro, After Effects, Audition, Photoshop, Lightroom, Illustrator, InDesign, Acrobat Pro, Final Cut Pro, color correction, retouching, motion graphics

Workflow & Operations: Digital asset management (DAM), ingest, metadata, file naming, version control, archiving, logistics coordination, Microsoft Office, Salesforce, macOS

AI Tools & Workflows: Claude (Projects, custom skills, connectors, browser agent), ChatGPT, AI video generation tools, ElevenLabs (AI voiceover), Canva AI design tools; advanced prompt and creative-brief design, written AI operating rules and versioned SOPs, human-in-the-loop review and approval gates, AI-assisted concept development and pre-production, source-verified AI research and synthesis (no-fabrication rules, cited sources), structured data and spreadsheet tracking, connected AI workflows across Google Workspace and Airtable; Apollo and Clay for prospect research and outreach lists

Web, Social & Email: Squarespace website design and management (hernanmendez.com), social media content and management, email campaigns

Languages: English and Spanish (fluent)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Arrecife Photography | Tempe, AZ Mar 2018 **– Present**
Founder, Media Producer & Project Manager

- Manage photo, video, audio, livestream, and 360° projects end to end for commercial, architectural, real estate, and corporate clients, handling up to six projects a month in busy periods, from scope, budget, and schedule through capture, post-production, delivery, and invoicing.
- Storyboard every video project, including frame-by-frame stop-motion animated to sound and music; translate client goals into creative briefs, shot lists, run-of-show plans, scripts, and interview questions; keep stakeholders aligned through reviews and revisions.
- Hire, schedule, and direct freelance crew for larger shoots; coordinate equipment, locations, and on-site logistics.
- Produce and edit video in Premiere Pro, record and mix field audio in Audition, and deliver platform-ready assets for web, MLS, print, and social.
- Run digital asset management for all projects with consistent ingest, metadata, file naming, and version control for fast retrieval and reuse.
- Produce livestreams of live events, including charity auctions and youth sports games.
- Created and manage the company website (hernanmendez.com) on Squarespace; run Arrecife's social media and email campaigns.

- Specify, purchase, set up, and maintain the company's camera, lighting, audio, and 360° production equipment; troubleshoot gear on location; track equipment value and depreciation for budgeting and replacement planning.
- Designed and run AI-assisted operations for the studio: written operating rules and versioned SOPs with verification checkpoints and handoff documentation, reusable custom AI skills, and connected workflows across Google Drive, Sheets, Gmail, and an Airtable CRM, with human approval required before anything is sent, published, or submitted.
- Use AI tools for research, planning, and visual pre-production, including competitor benchmarking, a 2026 square-footage pricing model, grant and fellowship research tracked in a shared spreadsheet, AI-generated concept and character reference imagery for creative development, and client outreach drafts reviewed before sending.

Bella Baby Photography | Phoenix, AZ **May 2021 – Mar 2022**
Newborn Photographer & Trainer

- Photographed newborns and families in fast-paced hospital settings, including NICU and postpartum units, following strict safety and privacy protocols.
- Led the restart of on-site services at St. Joseph's Hospital and Medical Center after a pandemic pause, rebuilding working relationships with nursing staff.
- Trained and onboarded new photographers through live shadowing on lighting, workflow, and delivery standards.
- Delivered same-day edited galleries in Lightroom and Photoshop with consistent quality across high volume.

Marten Transport | Phoenix, AZ**Aug 2018 – Mar 2020**
Logistics Coordinator

- Coordinated freight across contracted carriers, matching capacity to lane-specific volume and monitoring the EDI system for available loads.
- Worked with management offices to develop pricing for larger customers and identified new lanes for growth.
- Contributed to 10–15% year-over-year growth in load counts and revenue; mentored and trained new team members.

Yelp / Yelp WiFi | Scottsdale, AZ**Sep 2015 – Apr 2018**
Senior Account Executive

- Advised small and mid-sized business owners across the U.S. and Canada on marketing strategy, translating goals into practical advertising plans.
- Selected for the first team supporting Yelp WiFi (formerly Turnstyle); helped pilot pricing, test client scripts, and run U.S. onboarding calls.
- Supported Spanish-speaking clients, adding $200,000 in revenue and consistently exceeding performance targets.

Mexicorp, LLC | Phoenix, AZ**Sep 2013 – Aug 2015**
Territory Account Representative

- Managed relationships with regional grocery chains, including Food City and Los Altos Ranch Markets, across Phoenix, Casa Grande, and Tucson.
- Coordinated product introductions into new stores across Arizona and New Mexico while working with remote teams in the U.S. and Mexico.
- Recognized in the region for most new products introduced and lowest product buy-back.

Lionsgate / Elicosma Production | U.S., Mexico, and GuatemalaMar 2012 – May 2014
Associate Producer, Cinematographer & Researcher

- Produced and shot documentary content for the award-winning Mayan Revelations: Decoding B'aqtun and Mayan Revelations & Hollywood Lies.
- Hired and coordinated international crews of up to 30–45 people; managed travel, security, equipment rentals, and location scouting.
- Secured filming permits for restricted archaeological sites through Mexico's National Institute of Anthropology and History (INAH).
- Captured stills, b-roll, and underwater footage (cave and open water); organized footage libraries and metadata for post-production and distribution.
- Built the original website and designed packaging and product presentations for the Replete Skincare project.

TM Advertising | U.S. and Mexico**Dec 2010 – Feb 2012**
BTS Photographer, 2nd-Unit DP & Digital Retoucher

- Supported national campaigns for American Airlines, Nationwide, and Texas Tourism with camera prep, lighting, b-roll, and behind-the-scenes stills.

- Retouched and delivered print and digital campaign assets, keeping color consistent between photo and video deliverables.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Graphic Information Technology
Arizona State University, Ira A. Fulton Schools of Engineering, Tempe, AZ | December 2025

Focus: commercial photography, video production, audio production, 360° imaging, stop-motion animation, visual storytelling

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), Industrial Design
Tecnológico de Monterrey (ITESM), Monterrey, Mexico

Relevant coursework: Mathematics for Design, Physics I and II, Mechanics, Principles of Electrical and Electronic Energy, Manufacturing Materials and Processes I and II, Computerized Drawing and Digital Modeling (CAD), Principles of Automotive Engineering, Ergonomics I and II

Professional practicum: Belvedere USA, Mexicali plant. Analyzed manufacturing methods and product designs; proposed redesigns to cut production cost, material use, and process waste while meeting client specifications.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Project Management for Designers; Trello for Agile Teams; Trello Essential Training; Creating a Communications Strategy
- IRB – Social and Behavioral Research (CITI Program); ARMLS Preferred Photographer
- Adobe Premiere Pro, After Effects, Audition, Photoshop, Lightroom
- Architectural Photography: Interiors and Exteriors; Photojournalism and Documentary Photography; Lighting with Flash